

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 959

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Dr. Carroll Van West for his service to the people of the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly recognize those devoted Tennesseans who endeavor to preserve and further the appreciation of the history of this State; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Carroll Van West has tirelessly promoted the love of history and an appreciation for historic preservation across the State of Tennessee and beyond for over forty years; and

WHEREAS, Dr. West has been recognized by national, state, and local organizations for his never-failing contributions to historic preservation; and

WHEREAS, Dr. West obtained his undergraduate degree from Middle Tennessee State University in 1977, his master's degree from the University of Tennessee in 1978, and his Ph.D. from the College of William and Mary in 1982; and

WHEREAS, in 1985, Dr. West was selected to join the Center for Historic Preservation at Middle Tennessee State University and thereafter, in 2002, became the director of the Center, a position he has held since then; and

WHEREAS, as director of the Center for Historic Preservation, Dr. West has directed the Tennessee Civil War National Heritage Area, served as editor-in-chief of the *Tennessee Encyclopedia of History and Culture*, and directed and consulted with organizations across the State of Tennessee and a number of other states to save important historic sites, develop historic trails, and assist with expanding National Register properties; and

WHEREAS, since 1984, Dr. West has served at MTSU as a professor of history, in which position he has inspired legions of students to pursue career paths as history teachers, historic preservationists, and history consultants; and

WHEREAS, Dr. West is well known as an author and editor; in addition to the *Tennessee Encyclopedia of History and Culture*, his many other books and publications include the *Tennessee Historical Quarterly*; *Nashville Architecture: A Guide to the City*; *A History of the Arts in Tennessee*; *Trial and Triumph: Readings in Tennessee's African American Past*; *Tennessee's New Deal Landscape*; *Tennessee History: The Land, The People, and The Culture*; and *Tennessee's Historic Landscapes*; and

WHEREAS, in 2013, Dr. West was named the Tennessee State Historian; and

WHEREAS, throughout his career, Dr. West has built a legacy of ensuring that historic preservation is a part of Tennessee's culture and ethic for generations to come; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Dr. Carroll Van West for more than forty years of dedicated service to the people of the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.